

Once you've adjusted the tour route to an almost 3D-level elevation and altitude, you can use the arrow keys or mouse to move along the route following the purple line that indicates the direction you should take.

You can save these directions for later reference to your My Places folder, found in the Places panel. Collapse the folder that contains your complete driving directions, right-click, and select "Save to My Places". The My Places folder is where you store your Google Earth place data. This can help you quickly revisit places you have been to before and want to view again, much like bookmarks. For more on marking and saving places, see §8.3.

8.3 Marking, Saving, And Sharing Places

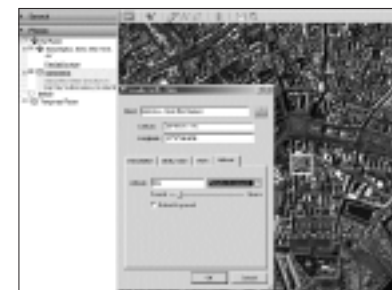
"Placemarks" are the Google Earth equivalent of bookmarks, and enable you to store information about a particular location. Placemarks should be saved in the My Places folder in the Places panel if you want them to be available during later Google Earth sessions. Items that are in the Places panel but not saved in the My Places folder will be stored in the Temporary Places folder, and will be lost at the end of the session.

To create a placemark, first select your location and choose the ideal viewing angle you wish to store it at. Select Add > Placemark from the menu, or press the Pushpin button on the toolbar. This will open the New Placemark dialog box with a yellow Pushpin button surrounded by a flashing yellow square centred in the viewer. Enter the required details in the dialog box.

Enter a name for the placemark in the Name field. Click on the Pushpin icon next to the Name field if you want to choose a different icon (from the icon palette). Use the Description field to add descriptive text that will balloon out when you click on the placemark. The text can also include HTML tags. When saved, the first few lines of text will appear as a snippet under the placemark in

the Places panel. You can also use HTML tags to add images either from your hard disk or from the Internet. In the Style and Color tabs, you can change the colour, scale (size) and transparency (opacity) of the Label (Name) and the icon.

The View tab enables you to choose a position for the bookmark. Move the mouse over each field to get an explanation of what the field does. In the Altitude tab, you can choose the height at which the placemark should be placed, and you can have a line extend to the ground



Create a placemark

from it by checking the Extend to Ground box. Once all the required information is entered, click OK to save the placemark. Whenever required, you can right-click on the placemark and select Properties to edit any details.

You can now share the new placemark with the Google Earth community via the Google Earth bulletin board system. To do so, right click and select Share/Post.

You will be taken to the Google Earth community site, where you will have to sign up. Due to the thousands of placemarks being created by Google Earth community members, you will be asked to ensure that you are not posting a duplicate; also, turn on the Google Earth community layer before posting your placemark to the Google Earth community site. See §8.4 for more on using and turning on layers. In short, the community layer includes all the placemarks posted by the Google Earth community to the bulletin board. This is updated every few months, and any placemarks you submit will eventually turn up in the Google Earth Community layer. Visit the Google Earth Community Web site at <http://bbs.keyhole.com>.